



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 11

GEORGIA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Georgia's family courts and child-welfare system.

56

GEORGIA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 83
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 20 MONTHS
MEDIAN TIME IN SYSTEM

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 20, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
10 OF 159

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

GEORGIA AT A GLANCE.

Across 56 Georgia families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 83 32 of 56 families reporting with kids	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$16,750 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 20 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 50.0% 30.4% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 56	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 2.6	REPORTING FAMILIES 32 of 56	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 10

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Georgia families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

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THE COST OF GEORGIA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	40	\$16,750	\$75,150	\$3,006,000
Lost Wages	34	\$10,000	\$81,405	\$2,767,786
Other Court Fees	23	\$0	\$2,390	\$54,975
Therapy / Evaluations	34	\$2,000	\$3,259	\$110,800
Reunification Services	24	\$0	\$2,633	\$63,200
GAL Fees	26	\$0	\$4,712	\$122,500
Asset Loss ¹	34	\$30,000	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$58,750	—	—

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$30,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		20	1.7 yrs
Mean months lost		35	2.9 yrs
Total across all families		1,268	105.7 yrs

03

WHO IS REPORTING · GEORGIA

Most families documenting in Georgia are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Currently involved / "S...		22	39%
Case closed (within th...		6	11%
Case closed (more tha...		5	9%
I am currently in an act...		1	2%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and ...		23	41%
Family Court Only		22	39%
CPS (Child Protective ...		3	5%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		13	23%
6 months – 1 year		12	21%
3 – 5 years		9	16%
5 – 10 years		8	14%
Over 10 years		5	9%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Los...		18	32%
Visitation Only		11	20%
Children in Foster Care		11	20%
50/50 Joint		6	11%
Full Custody		5	9%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Catoosa		4	7%
Gwinnett		4	7%
Stephens		3	5%
Brantley		2	4%
Lowndes		2	4%
Fulton		2	4%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Acc...		20	36%
Other: (Short answer)		10	18%
High Conflict Divorce		6	11%
Environmental/Poverty...		3	5%
False Accusations CPS...		3	5%

05 PARENT VOICES — GEORGIA

Quotes appear as submitted. Long submissions are trimmed with [...] to fit the page; the full unedited quote is available in the online version of this report.



This crooked system paints a false picture of scarcity, and then throws a meaty bone between two parties who used to care about each other, profiting from them tearing each other apart over it. My wife and I are kind people who love Jesus and love our kids. That hasn't helped [...]

— JOSHUA

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Through false statements, unlawful actions, and complete disregard for due process, this system tore my family apart and deprived me of irreplaceable time with my children. What they took from us cannot be measured or undone.

— GEORGIA PARENT · SAMANTHA

MORE VOICES FROM GEORGIA

My children have trauma and anxiety that never existed until DFCS was involved. Behavior issues now. My 4 year old son started wetting bed

— HALEY

Destroyed my whole life my kids are acting out violently towards each other mental health issues

— KELIA

Severed Mother son bond on zero facts all false allegations. Abuse of Power. My son is a weapon in family court and continues abuse.

— RHIANNON

It took an active and involved father away from a child's life and enabled the court to abuse a child with its default "legal" rules

— ANDY

My children were ripped away from me. Where they were going was planned long before court even happened. I wasn't given time to call family, they were going with my middle girls dad whom has 4 pending child abuse charges and battery. My 6 month old came home after 5 weeks with [...]

— APRIL

Destroyed my rights to be a mother to my only child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Ripped apart our bond, our loving relationship, our ability to be in each others lives, caused irreparable harm and emotional trauma to us all

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Literally wripped us all apart. All living different lifes and being in so much pain for what we love and miss and belong and cant have eachother.

— BROOKE

It has destroyed my families future in a few short months that I have worked decades trying to recover from prior bad actors in my life.

— LARRY

Destroyed my entire being inside and out. Made my kids think im crazy and dont love them. We lost all hope, trust, love and time. My kids didnt get to meet so many people who wanted and missed all the love and what family actually is.

— SAMANTHA

Ripped up a family that made me have purpose life with my 6 babies

— JOANNA

They allowed us to not be one. my kids have no education and do not know there real family who love and miss them.

— KARA

They have destroyed any security we once had in the Georgia medical system.

— PATRICIA

Taken precious moments that my children and I can never get back. Time cannot be reversed.

— ERIN

Destroyed this family. We will never be the same or trust anyone ever again.

— BRANDON

Ignored mental health, , and financial abuse

— JENNA

It has completely ripped our family apart!!

— JENNIFER

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



This has almost killed me, mentally and physically. I have PTSD from it.

— DEBANIE

It is caused three years of excruciatingly, painful heartbreak for my children for me

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has completely ripped our family apart!!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system turned my child's abuser into the victim and ripped she and I apart. I became the villain that the community, friends, and even some of my family turned against because he seemed like such a nice guy. I was victimized by the system. My child was and is victimized by [...]

— AMANDA

This system has mentally ruined my children's sense of safety, they trust nobody, my baby screens every time he has to leave, we get treated like trash and belittled and never get to speak for ourselves even when they are blatantly lying. Ever time they give me a finish line [...]

— AMANDA

Destroyed my child's ability to feel protected and loved.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Gwinnett County Court system kidnapped my daughter.

— JENNA

My daughter lost her mom, 3 Siblings and suffered psychological trauma with educational disabilities and no medical care for a year

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Crying, willing to share by phone.

— HEIDI

Destroyed my family. Caused significant harm to my children. Smeared my name. Lost all of the money that was left to me from where my husband died overseas. Money that was left to take care of my children was lost to this.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Changed the entire dynamics of our entire life.

— KORTNEY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Changed the entire dynamics of our entire life.

— KORTNEY

The system ignores true parental alienation. The system is broken and only relies on fast talking attorneys who only present one side of the information. Judges that are biased and small towns that probably have connections with specific families. This has robbed me of my mother [...]

— CHER

Ruined the innocence of our child and ruined my life

— DOUG

The court never held the habitual absconding mother accountable to visitation violations.

— STEPHEN

“Despite the family court’s attempts to break me and the threats against my safety, I stand unwavering and unbowed, a testament to resilience and the indomitable spirit of a mother.”

— HANNAH

They have ripped our ggbabies away from our entire family with not a scared of evidence of anything. I had temp custody of the oldest girl's when she was a baby.Used a my innocence of how the system worked when they returned her to parents.Due to a lie by caseworker and used [...]

— LARAINÉ

Tore my family apart, cause generational trauma for years to come. My two children did not get to grow up together for the first three years of my youngest son’s life, and that we faced challenges of building proper relationships, like siblings should naturally be able to do. I [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Attempting to systematically deteriorate if not destroy a pre-existing full-time loving bond between a daughter of a tender age and her father through the state sanctioned licensing of paternal rights -- GA is the last of 50 states to still require un-wed fathers to formally beg [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Medical coercion, violation of religious beliefs, covering up group home crimes, everything has been crooked including my public pretender

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Torn us apart for being poor

— STEPHANIE

From the day I called the police for help, every single person that came in contact with my child and I, from law enforcement all the way to the church and everything in between has failed us. The system aided our abuser, opening the door for him to continue his path of abuse [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This situation has resulted in irreparable harm. I have been deprived of time and the ability to protect my child. My child has endured immense suffering.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has aided in ripping two little girls away from their stay at home mother for no better reason than the mother couldn't afford the lawyer that their nearly absent father could.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

44 Georgia parents submitted ranked quotes. 43 appear in this report; the remainder are available at standwithmeg.com/ga.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Georgia report comes from Georgia respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Georgia — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 56 Georgia families reporting here are not the universe of Georgia families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics (email + name + submission date) are applied before aggregation. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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